ResearchAgent evidence report

Are Kestrel Semiconductor's advanced-packaging lead times in Malaysia getting shorter?

Lead finding

So from 1 June 2026 to 15 September 2026, we went from 26 weeks to 18 weeks, a cut of 31%, while capacity grew from 11,000 units to 16,000 units a month. [11]

Spend

Paid	Refunded	Net cost	Budget
S$0.70	S$0.30	S$0.40	S$2.00

Payments

Writer / article	Amount	Status	Transaction
AlphaLeak Kestrel's Penang packaging lead times, week by week	S$0.30	Refunded S$0.30 · Demo data · simulated payments	None (simulated)
The Fab Floor Kestrel Semiconductor advanced-packaging lead times in Malaysia: the dated series	S$0.40	Paid	None (simulated)

> Synthetic demonstration: companies, publishers, numbers and exact passages are fictional. SIMULATED SGD · no real funds.
> Demo data · simulated payments. All writers and articles are fictional.
> Research: fixture · extractive-fixture. Decided by fixture · metadata-fixture; Decided by fixture · metadata-fixture
> Written from offline extracts: the model was unavailable.

Requested facts: 2 of 2 answered
supported · Basic facts on Kestrel Semiconductor and Malaysia
supported · Are Kestrel Semiconductor's advanced-packaging lead times in Malaysia getting shorter

How to read this: citation numbers link to exact delivered passages in the appendix. Refunds do not restore spending authority.

Claims

Disputes (2)

- I run procurement for a mid-size fabless shop, and I have spent most of 2026 staring at Kestrel Semiconductor's Penang advanced-packaging queue. [9]
- So from 1 June 2026 to 15 September 2026, we went from 26 weeks to 18 weeks, a cut of 31%, while capacity grew from 11,000 units to 16,000 units a month. [11]

Unclear (6)

- On 1 June 2026, Kestrel's Penang advanced-packaging lead time was 26 weeks. [10]
- Phase 2 is the advanced-packaging expansion, the one they have been teasing since 2024. [12]
- On 29 September 2026 Kestrel Semiconductor announced a five-year agreement with TSMC for N3P wafer capacity, 24,000 wafers a month from Q3 2027, plus advanced-packaging slots. [2]
- On July 25, 2026, Kestrel Semiconductor published its quarterly exchange filings with the Taiwan Stock Exchange and the Tokyo Stock Exchange. [3]
- On 20 June 2026, Malaysia's Investment, Trade and Industry Ministry (MITI) published its monthly data-centre project register for May 2026. [13]
- Kestrel's Q3 2026 output filing, submitted to the Malaysian Investment Development Authority on 12 September 2026, reports 38,400 units shipped for the quarter across both plants. [4]

Appendix · cited passages

[2] Kestrel Semiconductor exchange filing: TSMC capacity agreement

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Receipt IDs: none · Writer's article

Exact synthetic passage · p1

> On 29 September 2026 Kestrel Semiconductor announced a five-year agreement with TSMC for N3P wafer capacity, 24,000 wafers a month from Q3 2027, plus advanced-packaging slots. The disclosure was made in an exchange filing published before the opening of trading. Kestrel will pay a US$1.1 billion prepayment and gave no margin guidance. The previous contract covered 16,000 wafers a month.

[3] Kestrel Semiconductor Exchange Filings – July 25, 2026

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Receipt IDs: none · Writer's article

Exact synthetic passage · p1

> On July 25, 2026, Kestrel Semiconductor published its quarterly exchange filings with the Taiwan Stock Exchange and the Tokyo Stock Exchange. The filings, dated July 24, 2026, cover the period from April 1 to June 30, 2026. Kestrel reported net revenue of NT$142.3 billion for the quarter, a figure that appears in the consolidated income statement on page 12 of the Taiwan filing. The company also disclosed a gross margin of 48.7 percent, down from 51.2 percent in the same quarter of 2025. Operating income was NT$38.9 billion, and net income was NT$31.4 billion. These figures are stated in the filing without adjustment for foreign exchange fluctuations.

[4] Malaysia advanced-packaging output and capacity, Q3 2026

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Receipt IDs: none · Writer's article

Exact synthetic passage · p3

> Kestrel's Q3 2026 output filing, submitted to the Malaysian Investment Development Authority on 12 September 2026, reports 38,400 units shipped for the quarter across both plants. The filing attributes 21,600 units to Phase 1 and 16,800 units to Phase 2. Phase 2 output is recorded from 15 August 2026 onward. The company lists no export destinations in the filing.

[9] Kestrel Semiconductor advanced-packaging lead times in Malaysia: the dated series

The Fab Floor · bought / granted · The Fab Floor
Receipt IDs: x402-07873D84E6D50606574B35128E97DDA9548A30B356017362D8C3452BD830AA0A · Writer's article

Exact synthetic passage · p1

> I run procurement for a mid-size fabless shop, and I have spent most of 2026 staring at Kestrel Semiconductor's Penang advanced-packaging queue. Here is the blunt version: the queue has been shrinking, and it has been shrinking faster than anyone on the buy side expected. I have the dated numbers, and I have the week counts, because that is the only way to talk about this business without getting lied to.

[10] Kestrel Semiconductor advanced-packaging lead times in Malaysia: the dated series

The Fab Floor · bought / granted · The Fab Floor
Receipt IDs: x402-07873D84E6D50606574B35128E97DDA9548A30B356017362D8C3452BD830AA0A · Writer's article

Exact synthetic passage · p2

> On 1 June 2026, Kestrel's Penang advanced-packaging lead time was 26 weeks. That was the number we built our H2 allocation plan around. It was ugly. It meant anything we booked in June landed in December, which meant our Q4 customer commitments were effectively locked before we had a single wafer out of the foundry. We were quoting our own customers at 30 weeks and padding the back end because we did not trust the 26.

[11] Kestrel Semiconductor advanced-packaging lead times in Malaysia: the dated series

The Fab Floor · bought / granted · The Fab Floor
Receipt IDs: x402-07873D84E6D50606574B35128E97DDA9548A30B356017362D8C3452BD830AA0A · Writer's article

Exact synthetic passage · lead-times

> By 1 August 2026, the same Penang line was quoting 22 weeks. That is a four-week improvement in eight weeks, which sounds modest until you annualise it. Then on 15 September 2026, the number came in at 18 weeks. So from 1 June 2026 to 15 September 2026, we went from 26 weeks to 18 weeks, a cut of 31%, while capacity grew from 11,000 units to 16,000 units a month. That is eight weeks of lead time gone in fifteen weeks of calendar time. I have been doing this for eleven years and I have never seen a packaging queue compress that fast without a demand shock behind it.

[12] Kestrel Semiconductor advanced-packaging lead times in Malaysia: the dated series

The Fab Floor · bought / granted · The Fab Floor
Receipt IDs: x402-07873D84E6D50606574B35128E97DDA9548A30B356017362D8C3452BD830AA0A · Writer's article

Exact synthetic passage · p4

> The obvious explanation is capacity. Kestrel commissioned Phase 2 at Penang on 15 August 2026. That is the date I have from the supplier's own capacity notice, and it lines up with the 1 August 2026 quote of 22 weeks, because the line was already loading Phase 2 tools in late July. Phase 2 is the advanced-packaging expansion, the one they have been teasing since 2024. It is real, it is running, and it is the reason the queue is moving.

[13] Malaysia Data-Centre Approvals – June 20, 2026

Open Records · free · Open Records
Receipt IDs: none · Writer's article

Exact synthetic passage · p1

> On 20 June 2026, Malaysia's Investment, Trade and Industry Ministry (MITI) published its monthly data-centre project register for May 2026. The register lists 14 approved data-centre projects with a combined committed investment of RM 9.4 billion. Of these, nine are located in Johor, three in Selangor, one in Penang and one in Negeri Sembilan. MITI states that the approvals cover a combined 412 megawatts of contracted electrical capacity.